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In all my tech gadget purchases over the years, from my first assembled PC to a phone I recently bought for my mother, I don't think I've ever even thought about buying a refurbished tech gadget. The thought never crossed my mind, as far as I remember, at the risk of sounding extremely entitled. But looking at the rising cost of flagship smartphones, and flagship features becoming more visible in budget smartphones, does it even make sense to buy a super expensive smartphone anymore?

That's a question not just me but increasingly lots of Indian tech buyers are asking, according to the massive boom in India's refurbished

gadget landscape since the pandemic years. The market, which was once seen as a niche segment, has now become a mainstream choice for many first-time and repeat consumers of tech. This surge can be attributed to several factors, including rising cost of the latest and greatest tech products, a growing awareness of sustainable consumption, and the increasing availability of high-quality refurbished products.

The refurbished tech market in India is not just limited to smartphones. It encompasses a wide range of products, including laptops, PCs, tablets, and gaming consoles, among others. The segment is driven by both online and